

Problem Architecture Canvas: Part 1

Project Name: _____ Date: _____

1. The "Why" (The Core Friction)

Do not write solutions here. Focus purely on the pain, the triggers, and the current reality.

A. The Surface Problem: *(What is the immediate complaint or issue?)*

B. The Root Cause (The 5 Whys): *(Ask "Why does this happen?" repeatedly until you hit systemic failure.)*

1. Why? _____
2. Why? _____
3. Why? _____
4. Why? _____
5. Why? _____

C. The Trigger Event: *(What specific event turns this from a minor annoyance into an urgent, painful crisis?)*

D. The Cost of Inaction (COI) & Current Workarounds: *(Quantify the pain. How much time/money is lost? How are they currently hacking together a messy fix?)*

Time/Money Lost:

Current Messy Workaround:

2. The "Who" (The Ecosystem Actors)

Be hyper-specific. If your "Who" is everyone, it is no one.

A. The Primary Actor: *(Who experiences the most acute, "hair-on-fire" pain? Describe them in detail.*

B. The Secondary Actors: *(Who else is impacted by this problem within the ecosystem?)*

C. Actor Constraints: *(What is stopping the Primary Actor from solving this themselves? e.g., Lack of capital, lack of network, systemic blocks.)*

Problem Architecture Canvas: Part 2

3. The "What" (The Desired State & Boundaries)

Define the exact shape of the resolution without mentioning any technology, product, or specific solution.

A. The Desired State Transition: *(What does their world look like BEFORE the problem is solved, and AFTER?)*

Before: >

After: >

B. Success Metrics (The Customer's KPIs): *(How will the customer definitively know the problem is solved? Use numbers if possible.)*

1. _____

2. _____

C. System Boundaries (What we are NOT solving): *(Explicitly list the adjacent problems you are choosing to ignore to avoid scope creep.)*

- We are NOT solving: _____
- We are NOT solving: _____

4. The Synthesized Problem Statement

Combine the work above into a single, cohesive, testable statement.

Template: We help **[Specific Who]** achieve **[Specific What / Desired State]** by overcoming **[Specific Why / Root Cause]**. Currently, they are struggling because **[Trigger Event / Constraint]**, which results in **[Cost of Inaction]**.

Your Problem Statement:

The Synthesized Problem Statement (Example): "We help first-generation natural farmers (managing 5-10 acres) achieve predictable, premium-priced market linkage by overcoming the lack of trust and traceability in unorganized wholesale markets. Currently, they are struggling because harvests of heirloom varieties like Kalabhatti and Navara are frequently mixed or undervalued by local mandis, which results in a 30-40% loss of potential revenue and forces them to spend 15+ hours a week desperately messaging individual consumer WhatsApp groups."

Solution Architecture Canvas: The "How"

Project Name: _____ Date: _____

1. The Core Proposition & Solution

How are we solving the synthesized problem from Part 1?

A. Unique Value Proposition (UVP): *(A single, clear, compelling message that states why your solution is different and worth buying. What is the core promise?)*

B. The High-Level Solution: *(Outline the top 3 core features or capabilities that will deliver the Desired State from your Problem Canvas.)*

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

2. Market Execution

How will this reach the customer and sustain itself?

A. Channels: *(Exactly how will you reach your Primary Actor to sell this? e.g., Local farmer meetups, direct WhatsApp outreach, BNI referrals)*

B. Unfair Advantage: *(What do you have that cannot be easily copied or bought by a competitor? e.g., Exclusive partnerships, insider domain expertise, a pre-existing community)*

3. The Business Engine

How does the money and value flow?

A. Revenue Streams: *(How will you charge for this? e.g., Commission per transaction, monthly subscription, flat fee)*

B. Cost Structure: *(What are the fixed and variable costs to run this at a basic level? e.g., Travel costs, basic software subscriptions, manual labor hours)*

C. Key Metrics: *(What 1-2 numbers will tell you if the business model is actually working? e.g., Number of paid transactions per week, customer retention rate)*

1. _____
2. _____

Execution Reality Check: The "When"

4. Assumption Mapping

Every business plan is a list of untested assumptions. We must test the riskiest ones first.

List your top 3 assumptions required for this business model to work: (e.g., "Farmers are willing to wait 5 days for payment," or "Consumers will pay a 20% premium for certified organic.")

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

The Reality Check: Which of those assumptions has the **highest impact** if you are wrong, but you currently have the **least evidence** that it is true? *(This assumption becomes the entire focus of your Phase 1 MVP).*

The Riskiest Assumption to Test First: >

5. The MVP Phasing Staircase

Do not build a platform until you have validated the demand manually.

Phase 1: The Concierge Test (Validation Phase) *Goal: Do it entirely manually for your first customer to prove they will pay. (What is the cheapest, fastest way to manually deliver the core value this week?)*

Action Plan: >

Timeframe to Launch: _____

Phase 2: The Wizard of Oz (Process Phase) *Goal: Fake the automation. The front-end looks real, but you do the work manually in the background. (How will you handle 10 customers without writing custom code? e.g., WhatsApp Business + Google Sheets + Manual matchmaking)*

Action Plan: >

Trigger to start Phase 2: (e.g., When we successfully complete 3 Concierge transactions)

Phase 3: The Minimum Viable Architecture (System Phase) *Goal: Build the absolute minimum tech required to automate the bottlenecks from Phase 2. (What is the first piece of technology actually required to scale from 10 to 100 customers?)*

Action Plan: >

Trigger to start Phase 3: (e.g., When the manual process breaks because of too much volume)